



» ALL THE SEASONS
Clockwise from right, Soghra Khurasani's 'Grounded', a canvas by Atul Dodiya, a painting by Christopher Kulendran Thomas, and work by Paul BeumerBeumer

ART

Coming Together

The ongoing* Mumbai Gallery Weekend *is a platform for both established and emerging artists





The Mumbai Gallery Weekend (MGW) has returned from Jan. 9–12, marking its 13th edition. Organised by the Mumbai Gallery Association, the annual event is a key feature of the city's cultural landscape. Featuring 37 galleries and spaces, MGW 2025 has a rich programme of exhibitions, curated walkthroughs and engaging discussions. Since its inception, MGW has been a platform for renowned and emerging artists, drawing audiences from across the globe. Among this year's highlights:

- **Atul Dodiya's** *Radio Ceylon Paintings: Vol. I* at Chemould Prescott Road, evoking nostalgia through music.
- **Rana Begum's** stunning works at Jhaveri Contemporary, blending light, geometry, and colour.
- **Christopher Kulendran Thomas**'s debut solo exhibition at Experimenter Colaba, exploring diasporic identity and cultural history.
- **Interactive events**, like curated walkthroughs by Art & Wonderment, offer audiences deeper insights into the ideas behind the works.

This year's line-up also features exhibitions that demonstrate the dynamic role of galleries as cultural innovators:

The Mumbai Gallery Association's annual event has made Mumbai a hub of contemporary art

- **Gallery Maskara:** T. Venkanna's *Black Blue Yellow*, a compelling exploration of war and sexuality through monumental ink brush paintings.
- **Galerie Isa:** Santiago Giralda's *Maps of the Invisible*, a four-metre triptych that reimagines contemporary visual narratives.
- **TARQ:** Soghra Khurasani's *Grounded*, reflecting on humanity's relationship with nature through intricate prints.
- **Artisans':** Paul Beumer's collaboration with Tamil Nadu weavers, reinterpreting Madras checks in vibrant new forms.

Mumbai Gallery Weekend was born out of a shared commitment to fostering art. In 2008, the contemporary art market faced a sudden downturn, marked by plummeting demand and dwindling everyday audiences. Despite these challenges, Mumbai's galleries persevered, driven by a vision to sustain the art ecosystem. They rethought strategies, creating new ways to engage audiences and build a lasting art culture in the city. From experiments like Art Night Thursday, which extended gallery hours, to the launch of MGW in 2012, these efforts transformed Mumbai into a hub for contemporary art. ■

–Nikhil Sardana

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The Symphony Orchestra of India (SOI) will enthral audiences with its Spring 2025 Season, running from Jan. 25 to Feb. 15. Featuring the legendary Zubin Mehta and the SOI debut of Sir Mark Elder, the season promises a rich array of symphonic and concerto masterpieces, and operatic favourites.

Maestro Zubin Mehta's return to the SOI is among the most anticipated highlights. Reflecting on his return, Khushroo N. Suntook, chairman of the National Centre for the Performing Arts (NCPA) and co-founder of the SOI, shared, "Maestro Zubin Mehta's return to the SOI is always a momentous occasion. When he first heard the orchestra last year, we had a small surprise by

